

# Mentorship: When Certifications, Experience, a Degree and Skills are Not Enough...

By: Brad Voris





# A Show of hands...



Who came here looking for a mentor?

Who came here looking to become a mentor?

Who came here looking to learn the process?



# Brad Voris, (a whole bunch of acronyms)

- Security Professional (Engineer/Manager/Architect)
- 25+ years of experience IT/IS/CS
- Undergrad in Cybersecurity @ Wilmington University
- Certifications: CISSP, CISM, CCSP, CCSK, Network+, MTA, MCP, etc.
- Co-Author 2 books: Intrusion Detection Guide and Essentials of Cybersecurity for Peerlyst
- Cloud Security Alliance Zero Trust Training Contributor
- **NOT AN EXPERT**



**How do I break in to cyber?**

**Built a home lab...**

**My professor said all I needed was a degree...**

**Got some certs...**

**I've been in IT for years and can't get a Security Analyst role!**

**Top 1% TryHackMe / HackTheBox...**

**I custom tailor my resume for roles but don't get responses back!**



# What are leaders and organizations looking for?





**Experience**

| Experience Level | Percentage |
|------------------|------------|
| Not specified    | 0%         |
| 1 year           | 2%         |
| 1-3 years        | 19%        |
| 3-5 years        | 38%        |
| 5+ years         | 29%        |

**Education**

| Education Level     | Percentage |
|---------------------|------------|
| Associates          | 9%         |
| Bachelor's Degree   | 56%        |
| High School Diploma | 10%        |
| Master's Degree     | 3%         |
| Not Specified       | 22%        |

**Certification Requirements**

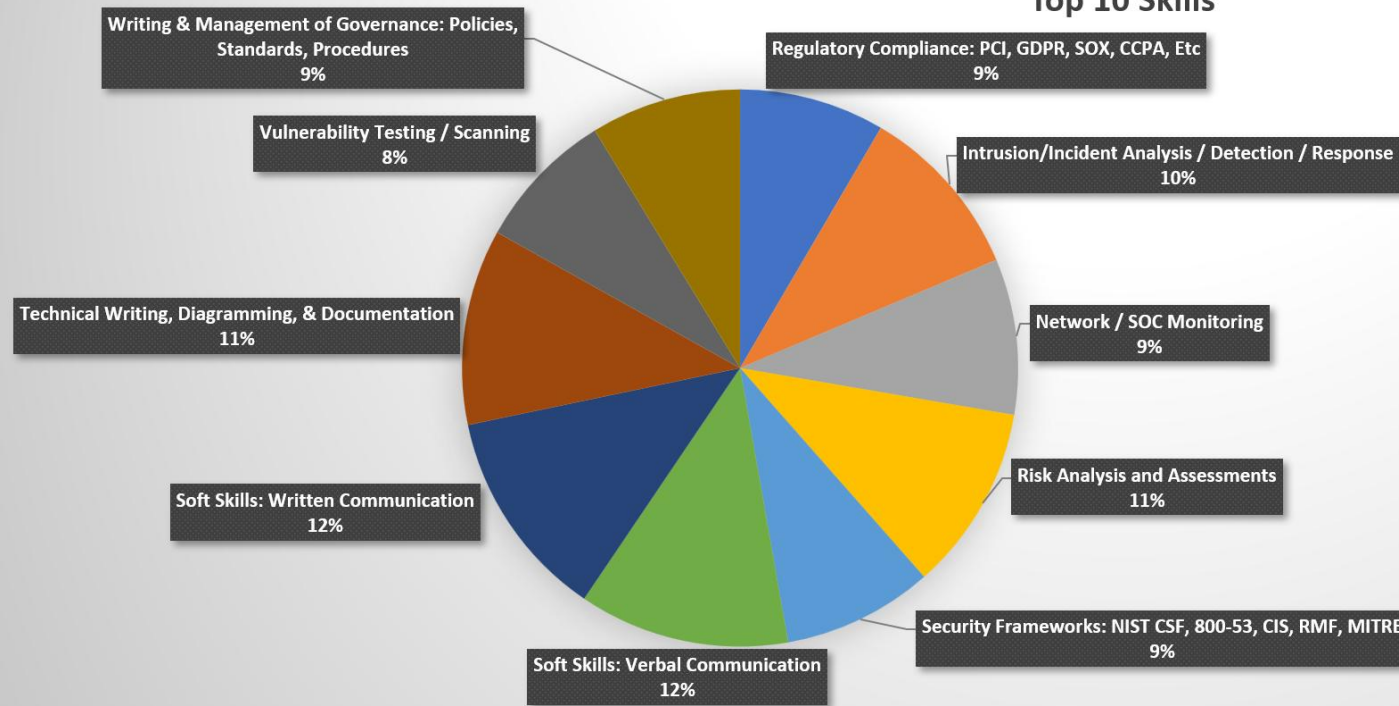
| Certification          | Percentage |
|------------------------|------------|
| AWS Security Specialty | 1%         |
| Axelos ITIL            | 1%         |
| Cisco CCENT            | 1%         |
| Cisco CCNA             | 1%         |
| Cisco CCNA Security    | 1%         |
| Cisco CCNP             | 1%         |
| Cisco Cyber Ops        | 1%         |

Job Skill Requirements

| Job Skill                                                      | Requirements |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| APSEC: SAST, DAST, ETC.                                        | 2            |
| CLOUD COMPUTING & SECURITY                                     | 12           |
| CLOUD PROVIDERS: AZURE, ORACLE, AWS, GCP, M365                 | 16           |
| REGULATORY COMPLIANCE: PCI, GDPR, SOX, CCPA, ETC               | 29           |
| DATA LOSS PREVENTION DLP                                       | 7            |
| DISASTER RECOVERY / BUSINESS CONTINUITY PLANNING / BUSINESS... | 5            |
| EMAIL SECURITY / PHISHING CAMPAIGNS                            | 10           |
| ENCRYPTION TOOLS / CRYPTOGRAPHY                                | 10           |
| ENDPOINT SECURITY: PROTECTION / EDR/MDR/XDR / ANTIVIRUS        | 27           |
| DIGITAL FORENSICS DFIR & FORENSIC TOOLS                        | 27           |
| EVALUATE SECURITY ASSESSMENTS                                  | 18           |
| HARDWARE IT/OT/IOT                                             | 9            |
| IAM: ACTIVE DIRECTORY, ENTRA ID/AZURE ACTIVE DIRECTORY         | 12           |
| IAM: MFA, SSO, SAML, OAuth                                     | 6            |
| IAM: IDENTITY LIFECYCLE MANAGEMENT                             | 4            |
| INTRUSION/INCIDENT ANALYSIS / DETECTION / RESPONSE             | 18           |
| MOBILE DEVICE MANAGEMENT                                       | 35           |
| NETWORK (SOC) MANAGEMENT MDM                                   | 2            |
| NETWORK SECURITY: SOC MONITORING                               | 31           |
| NETWORK SECURITY: FIREWALLS / WAF                              | 14           |
| NETWORK SECURITY: IDS/IPS                                      | 18           |
| NETWORKS: SIEM, SPLUNK, SENTINEL, CHRONICLE                    | 19           |
| NETWORKS: ROUTERS, SWITCHES, DNS, DHCP, TCP/IP                 | 24           |
| PATCH & CONFIGURATION MANAGEMENT                               | 5            |
| PENETRATION TESTING                                            | 19           |
| PROBLEM SOLVING                                                | 10           |
| RISK ANALYSIS AND ASSESSMENTS                                  | 7            |
| SCRIPTING/CODING/DEVELOPMENT: PYTHON, POWERSHELL,...           | 28           |
| SECURITY AWARENESS TRAINING                                    | 37           |
| SECURITY FRAMEWORKS: NIST CSF, 800-53, CIS, RMF, MITRE         | 18           |
| SECURITY POSTURE MANAGEMENT                                    | 9            |
| SERVER OPERATING SYSTEMS: MS WINDOWS SERVER, LINUX             | 30           |
| SOFT SKILLS: BUSINESS REVIEW                                   | 22           |
| SOFT SKILLS: LEGAL COMMUNICATION                               | 13           |
| SOFT SKILLS: WRITTEN COMMUNICATION                             | 15           |
| SOFT SKILLS: VERBAL COMMUNICATION                              | 10           |
| THREAT RESEARCH / INTELLIGENCE & DOCUMENTATION                 | 42           |
| TICKET MANAGEMENT                                              | 42           |
| THREAT ANALYSIS / HUNTING                                      | 39           |
| THREAT MODELING                                                | 10           |
| THREAT TESTING / SCANNING                                      | 9            |
| VIRTUALIZATION / HYPER-V / VMWARE / VDI                        | 28           |
| WRITING & MANAGEMENT OF GOVERNANCE: POLICIES, STANDARDS,...    | 3            |
|                                                                | 30           |

www.VictimOfTechnology.com / www.github.com/bvoris

## Top 10 Skills



- Regulatory Compliance: PCI, GDPR, SOX, CCPA, Etc
- Intrusion/Incident Analysis / Detection / Response
- Network / SOC Monitoring
- Risk Analysis and Assessments
- Security Frameworks: NIST CSF, 800-53, CIS, RMF, MITRE
- Soft Skills: Verbal Communication
- Soft Skills: Written Communication
- Technical Writing, Diagramming, & Documentation
- Vulnerability Testing / Scanning
- Writing & Management of Governance: Policies, Standards, Procedures

## Additional Key Points:

- Have a **passion** for learning and technology
- Have **fundamental knowledge** of people, process, data and technology
- Be **flexible** and **adaptable** with a willingness to learn



# What is my Mentorship Program?

## Initial Connection:

- Mentee will get a Career Planning Guide and instructions
- Copy of current Security Analyst Research 2025

## 1 Hour Session:

- One on One Conversation: Who I am, who you are, and what you want to do
- Review of Career Planning Guide: Build a road map based on what you want to do
- Network Establishment on LinkedIn

## Future Sessions May Also Include:

- Resume Reviews
- Mock Interviews
- LinkedIn Profile Reviews
- Skill Assessments
- Further Network Development





# What's the catch?

- There are no fees for mentorship
- Know what you want to accomplish
- Be respectful of your time and mine
- Frequent updates are required
- Once you've arrived at a place in your career where you are asked to be a mentor, it is now your responsibility to help others.



# Q & A

